

Driving Licence Tutorial

Transport • Online & Offline • Estimated time: 35 min

Overview

Driving licences are issued by state RTOs through the Parivahan Sarathi portal. You first obtain a learner's licence, wait 30 days, then take the driving test for a permanent licence.

Eligibility

- 18 years or older for a geared two-wheeler or car
- 16 years for a 50cc gearless two-wheeler with guardian consent
- Valid learner's licence held for at least 30 days before the driving test

Required Documents

- Aadhaar card — PDF / JPG. Used for e-KYC and address proof.
- Age proof — PDF. Birth certificate, PAN or school certificate.
- Passport-size photo — JPG, under 200 KB. Recent, plain background.
- Form 1 medical certificate — PDF. Required for applicants above 40 or for transport licences.

Charges & Timeline

Government fee: ₹200

Service charge: ₹1,000 for smart card DL

Processing time: 7–30 days

Payment methods: UPI, Net Banking, Debit / Credit Card, Cash at centre

Step-by-Step Guide

Step 1: Open Parivahan Sarathi

Go to parivahan.gov.in/sarathiservice, choose your state, then 'Apply for Learner Licence'.

Step 2: Complete Aadhaar authentication

Choose 'Submit via Aadhaar authentication' so details auto-fill and no RTO visit is needed for the LL test.

Tip: Aadhaar e-KYC lets you take the learner's test from home.

Step 3: Upload documents and photo

Attach age proof, address proof, signature and photograph in the sizes shown on screen.

Step 4: Pay the fee and take the LL test

Pay online, then attempt the 10-question road-sign test. You need 6 correct answers to pass.

Note: The learner's licence PDF downloads immediately after passing.

Step 5: Book the driving test

After 30 days, apply for the permanent licence and book a slot at your RTO's driving test track.

Warning: Arrive with the vehicle class you applied for — the test is cancelled otherwise.

Step 6: Collect your smart card

On passing, the smart card DL is printed and dispatched by post within 2–3 weeks.

Common Mistakes

- Booking the driving test before the mandatory 30-day gap
- Uploading a signature image larger than the allowed size
- Forgetting to carry the learner's licence to the test track

Frequently Asked Questions

Can I take the learner's test at home?

Yes, with Aadhaar authentication most states allow the learner's test to be taken online.

When should I renew?

Renew within one year of expiry to avoid a fresh test. Licences are valid for 20 years or until age 50.

Official Portal

<https://parivahan.gov.in>

GovGuide India is an independent learning platform. Always complete your application on the official government portal. We never ask for Aadhaar numbers, OTPs or documents.